

Gateway

Access to on premise data to Power BI is done through gateways.

The system that lets us connect our on-premises data sources to the Power BI service is called the **Gateway**. It's a small application that runs on our computer, and uses a pre-arranged schedule to connect to our data, gather any updates, and push them up to the Power BI service.

On-premises data gateway

The on-premises data gateway acts as a bridge, providing quick and secure data transfer between on-premises data (data that is not in the cloud) and the Power BI, Microsoft Flow, Logic Apps, and PowerApps services.

Formally called the enterprise version. Multiple users can share and reuse a gateway in this mode. For Power BI, this includes support for both scheduled refresh and Direct Query.

Requirements

Minimum Requirements:

- .NET 4.5 Framework
- 64-bit version of Windows 7 / Windows Server 2008 R2

Recommended:

- 8 Core CPU
- 8 GB Memory
- 64-bit version of Windows 2012 R2

Power BI Gateway - Personal

The **Power BI Gateway - Personal** acts as a bridge, providing quick and secure data transfer between the Power BI service and on-premises data sources that support refresh.

The personal gateway is only available with Power BI Pro. It installs and runs as a service on your computer.

Data transfer between Power BI and the gateway is secured through Azure Service Bus. The Service Bus creates a secure channel between the Power BI service and your computer.

This is for Power BI only and can be used as an individual without any administrator configuration. This can only be used for on-demand refresh and scheduled refresh.

Do I need a gateway?

Before we install a gateway, it's important to know whether or not we really need one. It really depends on our data sources:

On-premises data sources

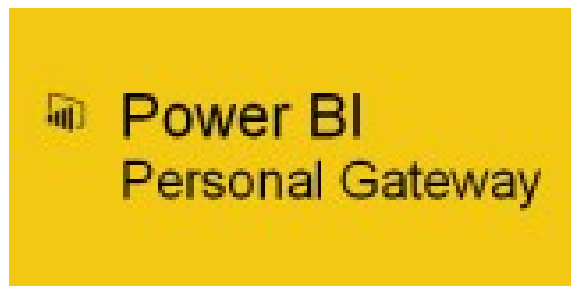
A personal gateway *is required* in order to refresh datasets that get data from a supported on-premises data source in your organization.

With a gateway, REFRESH NOW and SCHEDULE REFRESH are supported for datasets uploaded from: Ms excel and various other sources

Online data sources

A gateway *is only required* if we are using the **Web. Page** function. In other cases, a gateway is *not* required in order to refresh datasets that get data only from an online data source.

What is Power BI Personal Gateway?



As the name suggests, this gateway is for “personal” use. To use it you simply **install it on your own laptop**, desktop computer or even a server if you want. “Personal” does not mean you can’t use it for business if you want to, it is just a term to distinguish from the other gateway. **What the Personal Gateway does is create a “gateway” or connection between your computer** (that has the software installed) **and the Power BI Service in the cloud**. It is kind of like a dedicated VPN designed just to allow Power BI to talk to the data on your computer.

Why do I need it?

Well **you probably don’t “need” it, but you certainly might “want” it**. Once you have installed and configured the Personal Gateway on your computer, you are then able to refresh your Power BI datasets directly in the cloud. You have the option to either set

up an automated schedule (up to 8 times per day) or you can trigger the refresh manually on demand.

When you refresh a Power BI Desktop file on your PC, Power BI Desktop connects to all the data sources it needs to refresh the report. Data sources can include things such as SQL Server, local Excel files, CSV files, or what ever you have set as your data sources for your reports. The Power BI Personal Gateway simply allows [PowerBI.com](https://powerbi.com) **to access those same data sources that are visible on your PC transparently over the Internet.**